



Panasonic to go open source

Says it is seriously considering building phones for the Android platform

third revamp of the original Blackjack. The Windows Mobile 6.1 smartphone is now available exclusively to AT&T customers in the US and powered by the nation's fastest 3G network. The handset is a sleek combination between a business and smartphone. It has a 3.2 MP camera, Wi-Fi, 256 RAM, GPS and a bevelled qwerty keyboard. It comes with Windows 6.1 that can be upgraded to the upcoming 6.5. The phone, like its predecessors is a message-centric handset and so the specially designed keyboard should help it maintain that status. The screen is slightly small for the standard we're come to expect out of smart phones – it's only 2.4 inches. Still, this series of phones is the largest selling of all Windows mobile phones. The phone features Microsoft Direct Push for enterprise and small business users, while AT&T Xpress Mail offers access to most major personal email accounts. The Jack also features over-the-air synchronisation of contacts, calendars and task lists with Microsoft Exchange Server or Xpress Mail.

In terms of entertainment, it has various music and video options. For music, you have AT&T Mobile Music service – an on-the-go music service that delivers access to a collection of music content, including access to XM Radio Mobile and more. For video, the phone comes with Windows Media Player 10 Mobile and a microSD slot that can take up to 16 GB, so you can carry a lot of stuff with you. Besides, AT&T's Cellular Video service gives viewers access to thousands of video clips on categories such as news, sports, weather and entertainment via streaming video.



Viruses may come crawling to phones soon

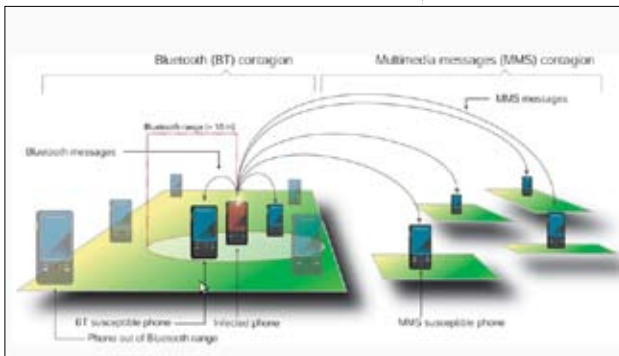
If you're reading this, chances are that you've probably dealt with at least one outbreak of virus infection on your computer at some point. Why is it then that these despised little pieces of code don't attack mobile phones even when they're now ubiquitous? In the US, mobile phone penetration is at about 80 per cent. Back home, the percentage may not be so large, but the sheer absolute number definitely is. The mobile subscriber base in India is close to some 360 million users. About 100 million of these are data-capable phones. Yet, there has not been a major or catastrophic outbreaks in the mobile realm. A recent

science magazine research team set about trying to find out why this is so and what kind of scenarios to expect if and when such an outbreak does take place.

The researchers studied calling and mobility data of six million anonymous users in the US. What they found was that the highly fragmented nature of market of operating systems is what has prevented an outbreak so far. The only type of phone that is susceptible to a virus attack is one that runs

an operating system – a smartphone. Considering that even in these difficult times, the growth of smartphones is 150 per cent annually, the time is not far when we see a full-fledged virus attack. But the study also predicts that viruses will pose a serious threat only once a single mobile operating system's market share grows sufficiently large. Once such a suitable environment is created for viruses, they can spread in two ways – Bluetooth and MMS. This

might remind you of a time around a few years ago when a Bluetooth virus was doing the rounds locally. The virus was actually a worm written for mobile phones running the Symbian operating system. So back then, we had lots of 6600s being infected with this pesky little thing. The worm called Caribe, was rated 'low



Credit: Pu Wang, University of Notre Dame, Physics Marta C. González, Northeastern University, Physics César A. Hidalgo, Harvard Kennedy School of Government Albert-László Barabási, Northeastern University, Harvard Medical School and Dana-Farber Cancer Institute


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